Past simple: irregular verbs

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

Qué vas a aprender

- Recognise irregular verbs (verbos irregulares) in a text
- Learn the 30 most common irregular past forms
- Use irregular verbs in affirmative, negative and question sentences
- Tell a short story in the past

Para pensar

Si «jugué» es *played*, ¿por qué «fui» no es *goed*?

Explicación

What is an irregular verb?

Regular verbs add -ed: play → played. Irregular verbs don't follow this rule. Each one has its own past form: go → **went**, eat → **ate**, see → **saw**, have → **had**.

The good news: like regular verbs, the past form is the **same for all persons**: «I went», «she went», «they went». And irregular verbs are very common, so you hear them all the time in songs, films and stories. **En castellano:** nosotros también tenemos irregulares: «ir» → «fui», no «í». En inglés es igual: hay que memorizarlos.



The top ten

Start with the ten most useful irregular verbs. You will use them every day: **go → went** (ir), **have → had** (tener), **get → got** (conseguir, llegar), **make → made** (hacer, fabricar), **do → did** (hacer), **see → saw** (ver), **come → came** (venir), **eat → ate** (comer), **take → took** (coger, llevar), **say → said** (decir).

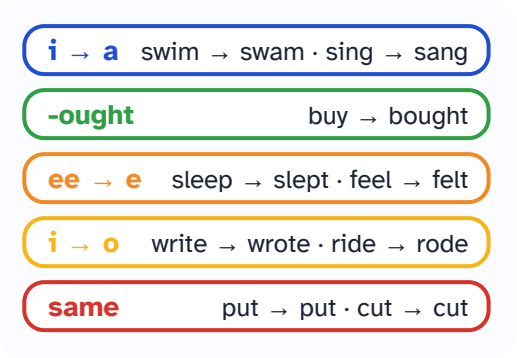
«I **went** to the park and I **saw** my friends. We **had** a picnic and we **ate** sandwiches. Then Marc **came** with his dog and **said** hello.»

Verb	Past	Verb	Past
go	went	see	saw
have	had	come	came
get	got	eat	ate
make	made	take	took
do	did	say	said

Learn them in families

Many irregular verbs change in a similar way. Learn them in families. **i → a:** swim → swam, sing → sang, drink → drank, begin → began, ring → rang. **-ought / -aught:** buy → bought, bring → brought, think → thought, catch → caught, teach → taught.

ee → e / ea → e: sleep → slept, feel → felt, meet → met, keep → kept. **o-e:** write → wrote, ride → rode, drive → drove. **Same form:** put → put, cut → cut, hit → hit, let → let. **Consejo:** agrupados se recuerdan mucho mejor que en una lista por orden alfabético.



More useful verbs

Here are more irregular verbs for your stories: **run → ran**, **sit → sat**, **stand → stood**, **fall → fell**, **find → found**, **lose → lost**, **win → won**, **give → gave**, **tell → told**, **read → read** (it is written the same but sounds «red»), **wear → wore**, **fly → flew**, **know → knew**, **leave → left**, **break → broke**.

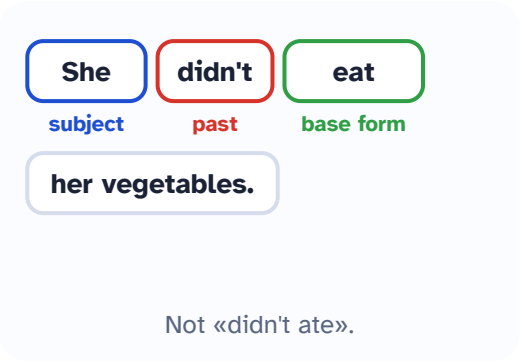
«The bird **flew** away.» «Our team **won** the match!» «I **lost** my keys, but my brother **found** them under the sofa.» «Grandpa **told** us a story.»



Negatives: didn't + base form

The negative works exactly like with regular verbs: didn't + the **base form** (the verb as in the dictionary). «I **didn't go** to the party.» «She **didn't eat** her vegetables.» «We **didn't see** the eclipse.»

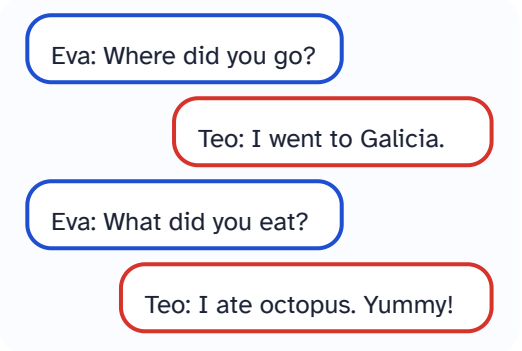
This is a big help: in negatives you **don't need** the irregular form. Not «I didn't went», not «She didn't ate». **En castellano:** piensa que *did* ya «lleva» el pasado; el verbo vuelve a ser el de siempre. Solo tienes que acordarte del irregular en las frases afirmativas.



Questions: Did...? Where did...?

Questions also use did + subject + **base form**: «**Did** you **see** the fireworks?» «Yes, I **did**.» «**Did** he **take** the bus?» «No, he **didn't**. He walked.»

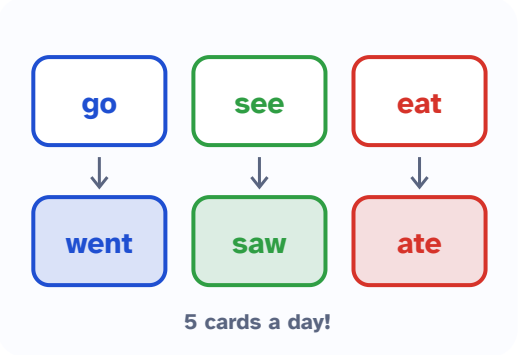
With question words: «**Where did** you **go** on holiday?» «**What did** you **eat**?» «**Who did** you **meet**?» «**What time did** the train **leave**?» The answer uses the irregular past: «I **went** to Galicia.» «I **ate** octopus.» «I **met** my cousins.»



Tricks to remember them

1. Flashcards: write the verb on one side and the past on the other. Practise five every day. **2. Rhythm:** say them with a beat, clapping: «go – went, see – saw, eat – ate!». **3. Memory game:** place the cards face down and find the pairs.

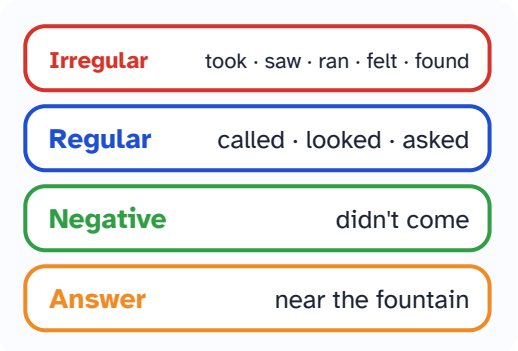
4. Your own sentences: use each new verb in a true sentence about you: «Last summer I **swam** in the sea.» **5. Read stories:** stories in the past are full of irregular verbs. **Consejo:** no intentes aprender cien de golpe. Con los treinta de este tema ya puedes contar casi cualquier cosa.



Reading: the lost dog

Read this story: «Last Sunday, Max **woke** up early and **took** his dog Coco to the park. Coco **saw** a squirrel and **ran** after it. Max **called** her, but she **didn't come** back. Max **felt** very worried. He **looked** everywhere and **asked** people. An old lady **said**: "I **saw** a small dog near the fountain." Max **went** there and he **found** Coco. She **was** wet and happy! They **had** an ice cream and **came** home.»

Underline the irregular verbs in red and the regular ones in blue. What did Coco see? Where did Max find her?



Let's practise: chain story

Play a chain story in groups of four. The first person says a sentence with an irregular verb: «Yesterday a dragon **came** to our school.» The next person continues: «It **ate** all the sandwiches.» «Then it **flew** to the gym.» «Finally it **fell** asleep in the library!»

Write your story and draw it in four pictures. Check each verb: is it regular or irregular? Did you use the base form after *didn't*? **Repaso:** afirmativa con la forma irregular; negativa y pregunta con *did* + verbo básico.

1 A dragon came to school.

2 It ate the sandwiches.

3 Then it flew to the gym.

4 Finally, it fell asleep.

Irregular verbs

learn them!

WENT

go → went
eat → ate

in families

SWAM

swim → swam
buy → bought

negative

DIDN'T

didn't go
base form

question

DID...?

Did you see?
Yes, I did.

Ejercicios

1. **Write the past: go, have, see, make.**

2. **Write the past: sing, drink, think, catch.**

3. **Complete: «Yesterday I ___ (eat) paella.»**

4. **Complete: «My aunt ___ (give) me a book.»**

5. **Make it negative: «We took a taxi.»**

6. **Make a question: «She wrote a poem.»**

7. **Ask with what: «He bought a skateboard.»**

8. **Correct: «I didn't saw the match, but my team winned.»**

9. **Which family? «keep → kept»**

10. **Write four sentences about your best day with irregular verbs.**

Practica

1. **The past of «go» is...**
   - **A)** goed
   - **B)** gone
   - **C)** went
2. **The past of «eat» is...**
   - **A)** ate
   - **B)** eated
   - **C)** eat
3. **The past of «buy» is...**
   - **A)** buyed
   - **B)** bought
   - **C)** brought
4. **The past of «swim» is...**
   - **A)** swimmed
   - **B)** swam
   - **C)** swum
5. **«I didn't ___ the film.»**
   - **A)** saw
   - **B)** seen
   - **C)** see
6. **«Did you ___ a good time?»**
   - **A)** have
   - **B)** had
   - **C)** has
7. **The past of «put» is...**
   - **A)** putted
   - **B)** pat
   - **C)** put
8. **«Where did they go?» — «They ___ to Paris.»**
   - **A)** go

B) went

C) did go

9. **The past of «sleep» is...**

A) slept

B) sleeped

C) slep

10. **Which verb is irregular?**

A) write

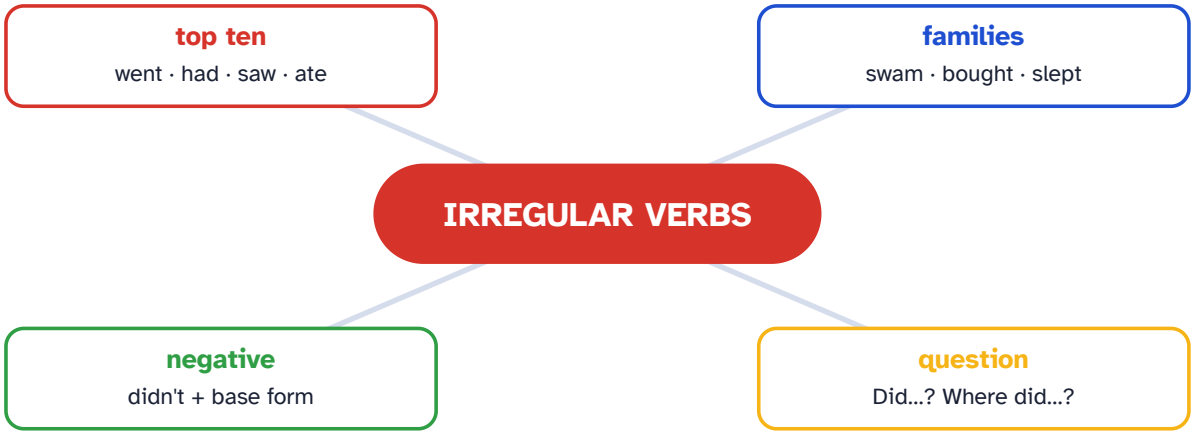
B) walk

C) play

Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Qué diferencia hay entre un verbo regular y uno irregular; Cuáles son los diez irregulares más usados y su pasado; Por qué en negativas y preguntas no se usa la forma irregular; Qué trucos ayudan a memorizarlos.

Resumen



Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

go → went

ir → fui.

have → had

tener → tuve.

see → saw

ver → vi.

eat → ate

comer → comí.

buy → bought

comprar (familia -ought).

swim → swam

nadar (familia i → a).

put → put

Igual en presente y pasado.

didn't + base form

I didn't go (no «didn't went»).

Soluciones

1. **C)** Irregular.
2. **A)** Irregular.
3. **B)** Familia -ought.
4. **B)** i → a.
5. **C)** Tras didn't, forma básica.
6. **A)** Tras did, forma básica.
7. **C)** Igual que el presente.
8. **B)** Respuesta en afirmativa: went.
9. **A)** ee → e.
10. **A)** write → wrote.

Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. went, had, saw, made.
2. sang, drank, thought, caught.
3. ate.
4. gave.
5. We didn't take a taxi.
6. Did she write a poem?
7. What did he buy?
8. I didn't see the match, but my team won.
9. ee → e, como sleep → slept y feel → felt.
10. Model answer: I went to the beach. I swam in the sea. We had lunch in a restaurant. I felt very happy.